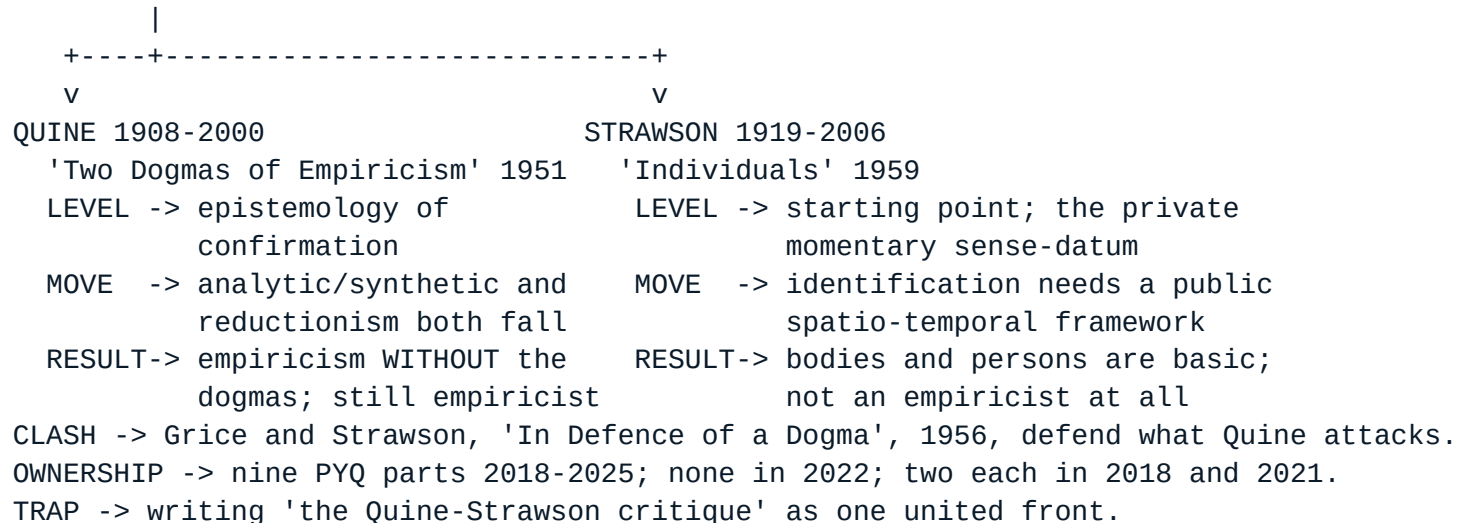


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: One heading, two projects: what the clause actually asks

START -> the clause reads: Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.

TARGET -> classical and logical empiricism, attacked at two different levels.



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: Dogma one: the circle of synonymy

CLAIM UNDER TEST -> there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.

ANALYTIC = true by virtue of MEANING

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MEANING -> requires SYNONYMY

|

+--> DEFINITION -> only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy -> CIRCULAR

|

+--> INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate

|

needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity -> CIRCULAR

|

extensional counter-case: creature with a heart / with a kidney

|

+--> SEMANTIC RULES (Carnap) -> defined via 'analytic-in-L' -> CIRCULAR

OUTCOME -> no principled, non-circular criterion of analyticity.

EXACT CONCLUSION -> a difference of DEGREE (centrality), not of KIND.

OBJECTION -> Grice and Strawson 1956: a usable distinction needs no definition.

REPLY -> usability is not theoretical legitimacy; compare witch / non-witch.

PROVENANCE -> Philosophical Review, January 1951; revised 1953.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: Dogma two and the web of belief

DOGMA 2 -> reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.

REFUTATION -> statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.

(o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY

\ \ | / /

[physics, chemistry, biology] <- revised fairly easily

[mathematics] <- revised rarely

[LOGIC] <- revised last, never immune

CLASH AT THE EDGE -> revise somewhere -> the place of revision is CHOSEN.

option A -> adjust a peripheral belief option B -> plead hallucination

option C -> revise a deep interior law

DOCTRINE 1 -> any statement can be held true come what may.

DOCTRINE 2 -> no statement is immune to revision, not even a law of logic.

CONSEQUENCES -> no analytic/synthetic line; no a priori/a posteriori line;
theory-choice by simplicity, conservatism, generality, fecundity;
the verification principle loses its application.

LIMIT -> minimum mutilation, Philosophy of Logic 1970, blocks 'anything goes'.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: The Duhem-Quine machinery and its two authors

TESTABLE CLAIM -> (H & A) implies O, where A is background theory and conditions.

|
OBSERVATION -> NOT-O

|
MODUS TOLLENS -> NOT (H & A) only: H is false OR some element of A is false.

|
LOGIC IS SILENT -> the conjunct to surrender is not dictated by the evidence.

|
RESULT -> refutation is never conclusive against a single statement;
 individual verifiability has no application; dogma 2 falls structurally.

+-----+			
Axis	DUHEM 1906	QUINE 1951	
+-----+			
Scope	theoretical physics only	the whole of science	
Logic & maths	exempt	included; none immune	
Corollary	no experimentum crucis	underdetermination	
+-----+			

CASE 1 -> Uranus: revise the auxiliary -> NEPTUNE, Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.

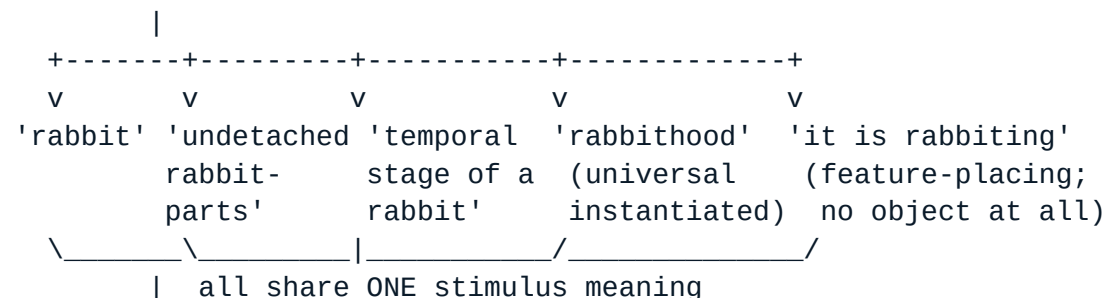
CASE 2 -> Mercury: 'VULCAN' fails -> revise the deep law -> relativity, 1915.

REPLIES -> Popper: falsification is a methodological decision, not pure logic.
 Lakatos: hard core plus revisable protective belt.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: Radical translation, gavagai and the three results

SET-UP -> radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter; evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent only. Word and Object 1960, ch. 2.

A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.



ASK 'same gavagai?' -> presupposes the identity predicate, articles, plurals, quantifiers: the APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION in dispute.

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RESULT 1 -> INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: no fact about what the terms refer to.

RESULT 2 -> INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: rival analytical hypotheses agree on all observation sentences yet differ elsewhere; nothing decides.

RESULT 3 -> ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY: reference only relative to a background manual.

PREMISES -> behaviourism about evidence; verificationism about facts; naturalism.

OBJECTIONS -> Chomsky: only underdetermination. Davidson: harmless, scale-like.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: Quine's positive system and the reform of empiricism

QUESTION 1 -> what is there?

CRITERION -> 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What There Is 1948.

METHOD -> regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.

CONSEQUENCE -> commitment is relative to the regimentation -> ontological relativity.

|

QUESTION 2 -> how do we know?

ANSWER -> naturalized epistemology; philosophy continuous with science,
'a chapter of psychology', 1968/69; sensory input to theoretical output.

IMAGE -> Neurath's boat: rebuilt plank by plank at sea, never in dry dock.

|

QUESTION 3 -> what happens to the a priori?

CHARGE -> no non-circular analyticity + universal revisability + no first
philosophy => holding a belief a priori is a metaphysical article of faith.

|

QUESTION 4 -> is empiricism abandoned?

ANSWER -> no: empiricism WITHOUT the dogmas; experience still governs belief,
holistically rather than sentence by sentence.

BRIDGE -> later Wittgenstein converges (museum myth rejected, holism, anti-private)
but parts on method: Quine REFORMS by regimentation, Wittgenstein DESCRIBES.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: Strawson's basic particulars and the identification framework

METHOD -> DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.

contrast -> REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.

provenance -> Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.

|

DEFINITION -> a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.

|

ARGUMENT FROM RE-IDENTIFICATION

1 objective thought requires re-identifying a particular as the same again

2 re-identification requires ONE unified spatio-temporal system

3 material bodies constitute it: three-dimensional, enduring, publicly located

4 sounds, events, private experiences are identified only BY reference to bodies

5 therefore MATERIAL BODIES are basic; PERSONS are the second basic particular

STATUS -> conceptual dependence, not causal or metaphysical priority.

|

TEST -> the purely AUDITORY no-space world

can 'the same sound returning' be distinguished from a duplicate? Only by a

MASTER-SOUND whose pitch fixes position -> a space-analogue is reintroduced.

VERDICT -> the experiment supports the thesis rather than defeating it.

OBJECTION -> Evans: the construction may smuggle in spatial notions.

2020 LINK -> spatio-temporal thinking is a precondition of OBJECTIVE thinking.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: Persons: the predicate matrix and the double demolition

THESIS -> the concept of a PERSON is logically PRIMITIVE; not mind plus body assembled.

+-----+-----+	
M-PREDICATES	P-PREDICATES
also true of mere	states of consciousness and action; only persons
material bodies	others by behavioural criteria; self without
'weighs 70 kg'	observation or criteria -> ASYMMETRY
+-----+-----+	

ARGUMENT

- 1 I self-ascribe P-predicates ('I am in pain')
- 2 a self-ascribable predicate must be understood as ascribable to others
- 3 other-ascription requires identifying others as single M-and-P subjects
- 4 therefore the person concept is presupposed by self-ascription itself

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BLOCKS CARTESIAN DUALISM

two independent substances cannot
be the ONE subject; P-predicates
become unlearnable and other minds
unknowable

v

BLOCKS THE NO-OWNERSHIP THEORY

'the experiences had by this body'
covertly restores the ownership it
denies; Schlick and Lichtenberg's
'it thinks' is self-refuting

GUARD -> not logical behaviourism: behaviour is criterial evidence, not meaning.

OBJECTIONS -> co-instantiation rather than primitiveness; Ayer on no-ownership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: Reference, presupposition and Strawson's own anti-empiricism

TEST SENTENCE -> 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king).

+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
Issue	RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905	STRAWSON, On Referring	
		1950	
+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
Who refers	the sentence, by quantifier	people, in a USE	
Existence	ASSERTED in the analysis	PRESUPPOSED, not asserted	
Empty term	the statement is FALSE	a TRUTH-VALUE GAP	
Meaning	truth-conditions of a type	rules for correct use	
+-----+-----+-----+-----+			

THREE LEVELS -> sentence (meaning) / use (truth-value) / utterance (voicing).

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STRAWSON AS CRITIC OF EMPIRICISM -> five distinct lines

- 1 sense-data cannot be basic: private, momentary, non-spatial [Individuals I]
- 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse -> person is primitive [Individuals 3]
- 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring]
- 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952]
- 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966]

FORM -> take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

HONEST LIMIT -> descriptive metaphysics maps our scheme, not mind-independent reality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: Confrontation, convergence and the reusable answer spine

+-----+		+-----+	
Axis	QUINE	STRAWSON	
+-----+		+-----+	
Method	naturalism	descriptive metaphysics	
Scheme	revisable come what may	core is indispensable	
Meaning	behavioural, indeterminate	fixed by public criteria	
Ontology	read off best science	the framework we must use	
Given	the whole web of belief	the public spatio-temporal	
		world	
+-----+		+-----+	

CONVERGENCES -> anti-Cartesian about a private inner object; the public and structured replaces the atomic and private; the museum myth of determinate private meanings is rejected by both.

DO NOT OVERSTATE -> they differ on status, meaning and method; 'they basically agree' is the standing trap on comparative stems.

STANDING PIVOT -> is the conceptual scheme REVISABLE or PRESUPPOSED?

GRADED VERDICT -> the periphery is Quineanly revisable; the framework role looks Strawsonianly indispensable; the truth is layered.

ANSWER SPINE -> 1 decode the directive and name the owner-thinker
2 thesis in one line
3 mechanism with the exact term
4 objection and reply, objector named
5 graded verdict with a provenance-clean date

TIERS -> 10 marks: steps 1-3 plus a verdict; 15: full spine plus one objection;
20: full spine, two objections and a convergence close.